

# HQ CuePlayer

## User Manual

Gapless CUE playback, one-click deployment and DSP scene presets for HQPlayer Embedded

Whole-file CUE

Zero-upload NAS

DSP Presets

Phone Remote

Image Splitting

v0.9 · 2026

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## 1. What it is

HQ CuePlayer is a **companion controller** for HQPlayer Embedded. HQPlayer does not play CUE sheets natively — HQ CuePlayer fixes that, turning single-file FLAC/WAV rips (and NRG/ISO/BIN images) into a track-level, gapless, cross-album playlist experience. It also turns every Linux chore — deployment, NAS mounts, DSP tuning — into one-click operations.

**What it is not:** it is not a playback engine and does not include HQPlayer. All decoding, resampling and output are performed by your own licensed HQPlayer — the audio path is bit-identical to the official pipeline.

## 2. What you need

| Item                               | Notes                                                                            |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A player running HQPlayer Embedded | x86 box, TV box or dev board (amd64 / arm64), with an activated HQPlayer license |
| A Windows PC                       | Runs HQ CuePlayer (Win10/11), same LAN as the player                             |

|                               |                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A NAS (optional, recommended) | SMB share holding your music; without one you can still drag-upload from Windows   |
| An NAA bridge (optional)      | A second device running NAA (e.g. a Pi feeding your DAC)                           |
| SSH credentials               | For the player (HQPlayer OS defaults to root with the password you set at install) |

### 3. Step 1 — Deploy hqpd over SSH

The server side of HQ CuePlayer is **hqpd**, a tiny daemon living on the player. Deploy once, forget forever:

- 1 Open the **SSH Deploy** page. Enter the player IP (or use **Scan** to discover it) and the SSH credentials.
- 2 Click **Deploy**. It auto-detects the CPU architecture, uploads hqpd, registers a systemd service and self-checks — about 20 seconds, all green.
- 3 ✓ API pairing token retrieved means secure pairing completed automatically. Nothing else to configure.

The screenshot shows the 'SSH Deploy' tab in the HQ CuePlayer web interface. At the top, there's a header with 'HQ CuePlayer', a language dropdown set to 'English', an IP input field containing '192.168.1.45', and buttons for 'Scan', 'Connect', 'Phone Remote', and a status indicator 'Connected ✓ hqpd 0.9.9'. Below the header are tabs for 'Player', 'NAS Settings', 'SSH Deploy' (which is active), and 'NAA Bridge'. The main content area is titled 'ONE-CLICK DEPLOY HQPD TO LINUX PLAYER' and includes a sub-header 'Auto: detect arch → upload binary → systemd install → self-check'. It features a 'Player IP' input field with '192.168.1.45', an 'SSH User / Password' section with 'root' and a masked password, and a row of buttons: 'Deploy' (highlighted in green), 'Test', 'Shutdown', 'Reboot', 'Restart HQPlayer', and 'Clear HQ Library'. A log area below these buttons shows a series of green checkmarks indicating successful steps: 'SSH connected to 192.168.1.45', 'Target arch linux/arm64', 'Binary uploaded', 'Installed to /usr/local/bin/hqpd', 'Write systemd unit', 'Start service', 'hqpd running', 'Deploy complete (ffmpeg not required; install manually when needed)', and 'API pairing token retrieved and saved (api\_token)'. At the bottom, there's a 'CUSTOM COMMANDS (RUN ON PLAYER)' section with a text area containing commands like 'journalctl -u hqpd -n 50' and a 'Paste multi-line commands, one per line; Ctrl+Enter to' button.

Fig. 1 — A successful deploy

**About passwords:** every field (including passwords) is remembered automatically and stored only in `hqcueplayer.json` on your own PC. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.

### 4. Step 2 — Mount your NAS

This lets the player read music straight off your NAS — the foundation of instant, zero-upload playback.

- 1 On the **NAS Settings** page (left column), fill in the player SSH address, the SMB share (e.g. `//192.168.1.26/music` ) and NAS credentials. Leave credentials blank for public shares — guest mode kicks in automatically.
- 2 Click **Test** to probe the SMB port first, then **Mount NAS**.
- 3 Keep **Write fstab** checked for boot-time auto-mount. Leave the protocol on Auto; only fall back to SMB 2.0/1.0 for ancient NAS boxes.

**HQ CuePlayer** Language **English** 192.168.1.45 Scan Connect Phone Remote Connected ✓ hqpd 0.9.9

Player **NAS Settings** SSH Deploy NAA Bridge

**NAS MOUNT (AUTO-MOUNT SMB SHARE ON THE PLAYER)**

Player SSH address  
192.168.1.45

SSH User / Password  
root \*\*\*\*\*

NAS Share (SMB)  
//192.168.1.26/9394/music

NAS User / Password  
wuyufu \*\*\*\*\*

Leave blank for guest mount (public share)

Mount point on Linux  
/mnt/nas

SMB 2.0 + nounix

☒ Write fstab (auto-mount on boot)

Test Mount NAS

Copy Log Clear Log

**HQLAYER WEB SETTINGS (8088 CONFIG PAGE CREDENTIALS)**

Digest credentials for the Embedded web config page (default hqplayer/password)

Web User / Password  
hqplayer \*\*\*\*\*

Open Web Settings

**PATH MAPPING (DRAG-DROP WITHOUT UPLOAD)**

Dropped files matching a mapping are read directly from NAS — zero upload. Hostname and IP treated as the same host. Separate multiple mappings with ;

Windows prefix  
\\192.168.1.26\9394\music

Linux prefix  
/mnt/nas

Save Mapping

**LICENSE**

Free: first 5 tracks per album + manual DSP; Pro unlocks: DSP scene presets / direct rate / image splitting / cross-album advance / unlimited playlists / phone remote

Status **Activated ✓ (pro / test@local / perpetual)**

Machine ID (send to seller for license.lic)

Fig. 2 — NAS Settings (left: mount; right: web settings, path mapping, license)

**If mounting fails:** the log tells you why (bad address, bad credentials, protocol mismatch). Anti-garbled-filename and anti-lockup parameters are built in, and if the NAS drops offline the player retries the mount every minute automatically.

## 5. Step 3 — Path mapping (zero upload)

Tell HQ CuePlayer "this Windows path equals that player path". From then on, dropping a CUE into the window makes the player **read the original file straight off the NAS** — multi-GB rips open instantly, not a single byte uploaded.

| Setting        | Example                                                                             |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Windows prefix | \\192.168.1.26\9394\music (as seen in Explorer; separate multiple prefixes with ; ) |
| Linux prefix   | /mnt/nas (the mount point from Step 2)                                              |

Click **Save Mapping**. Hostname and IP are treated as the same host, so either spelling works.

## 6. Connect & play

- 1 Enter the player IP and click **Connect** (or **Scan**). `Connected ✓` in the top-right means you're ready.
- 2 Drag **.cue files** (or whole folders, ISO/NRG images) from Explorer into the window. Tracks are appended to the current playlist.
- 3 **Double-click** any track to start. When an album finishes, the next album in the playlist starts automatically.

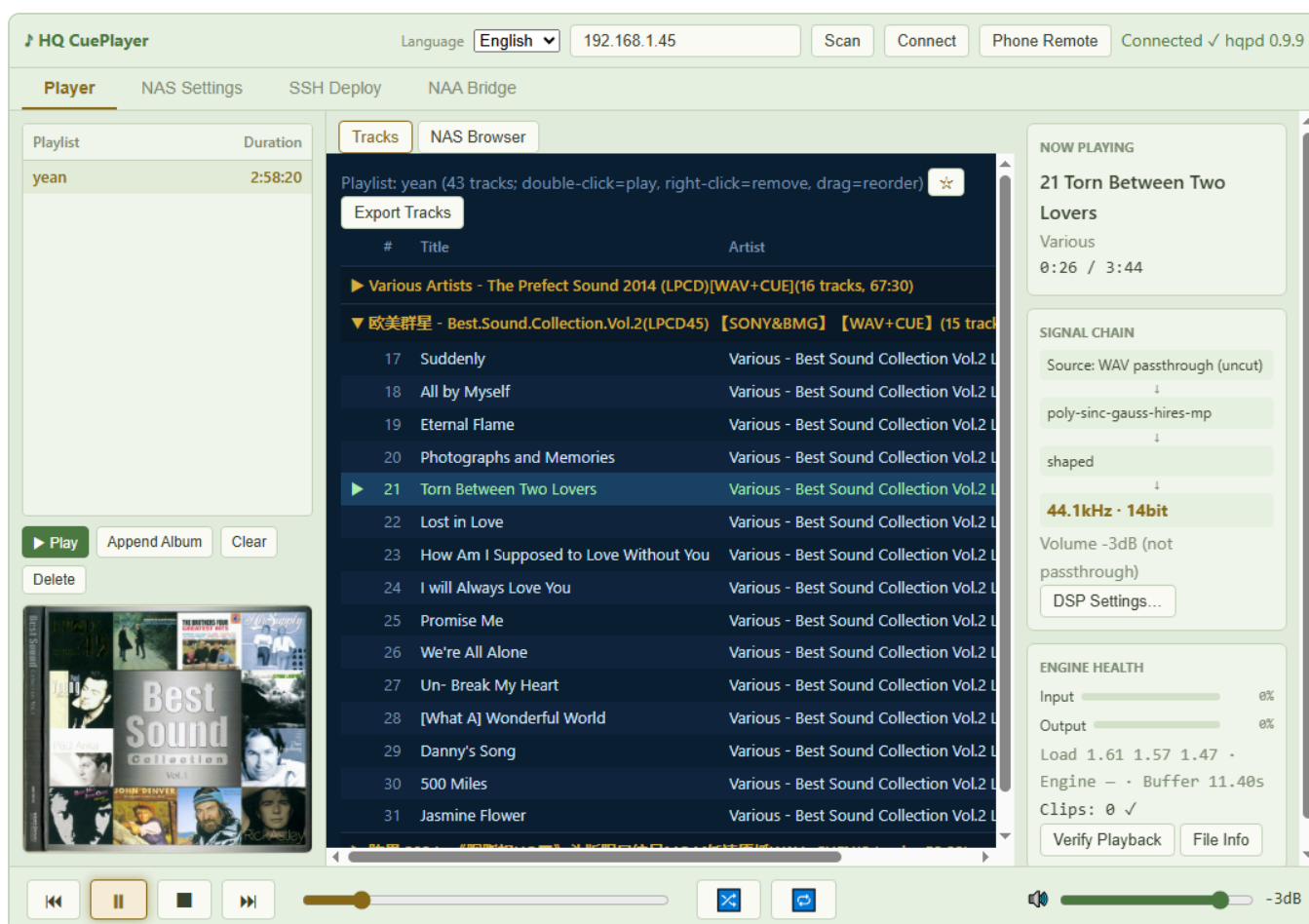


Fig. 3 — Player view: playlist, signal chain and engine health

## Everyday controls

| Action                     | Result                                                            |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Double-click a track       | Play from this track onward                                       |
| Ctrl+click a track         | Queue it next (after the current track)                           |
| Right-click a track        | Album view: skip (strikethrough); Playlist view: remove from list |
| Drag a track               | Reorder the playlist (saved automatically)                        |
| Click an album header ►/▼  | Collapse/expand the album                                         |
| DSP Settings (right panel) | Output mode / filters / shaper / rate (see §7)                    |
| ⏮ ⏭ (footer)               | Shuffle; repeat: off → all → one                                  |

The right panel is an audiophile's comfort zone: **Signal Chain** shows source format → filter → shaper → output in real time, and **Engine Health** shows load and the clipping counter. If Clips starts climbing, the DSP chain is over-amplified — pull the volume down 1–2 dB.

## 7. DSP settings & presets

Click **DSP Settings...** in the right panel: output mode (PCM / DSD), filter 1x/Nx, shaper and rate — all applied in real time.

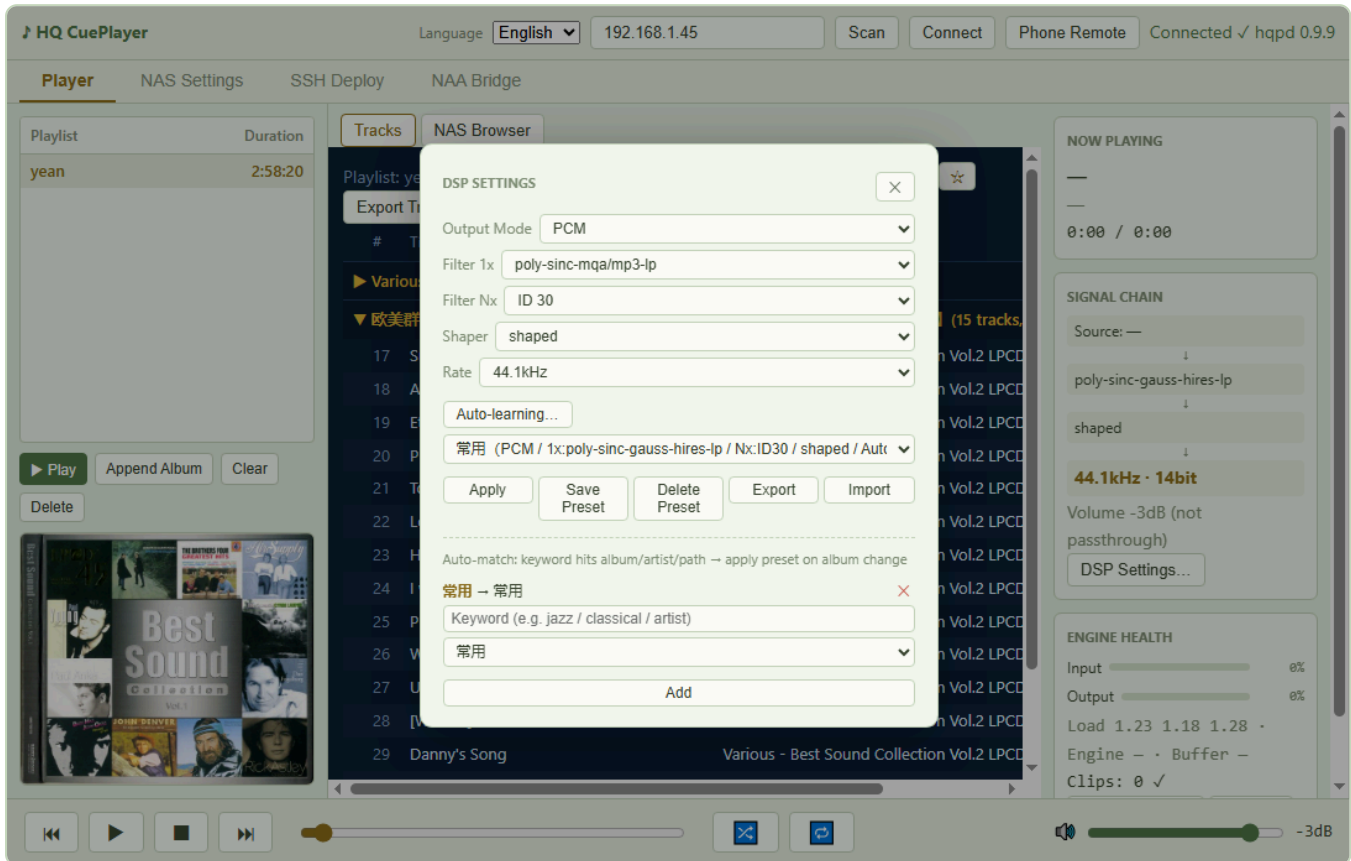


Fig. 4 — DSP settings with presets and auto-match rules

### Three power features

- **Learn All Filters** — scans and names every filter/shaper ID in about a minute. Click once after an OS reinstall (or whenever names revert to bare IDs).
- **Scene presets** — snapshot the entire chain (mode + filters + shaper + rate + volume) for one-click recall. One for classical, one for jazz, one for late-night listening. Export/import supported for backup and sharing.
- **Auto-match rules** — bind a keyword to a preset; when the album title / artist / path matches, the preset applies itself. E.g. keyword "jazz" → your jazz preset follows automatically.

## 8. Phone remote

Click **Phone Remote** and scan the QR code: play, skip, volume and DSP presets from any phone browser — no app to install. The phone talks directly to the player over your LAN, so **your Windows PC can be switched off afterwards**.

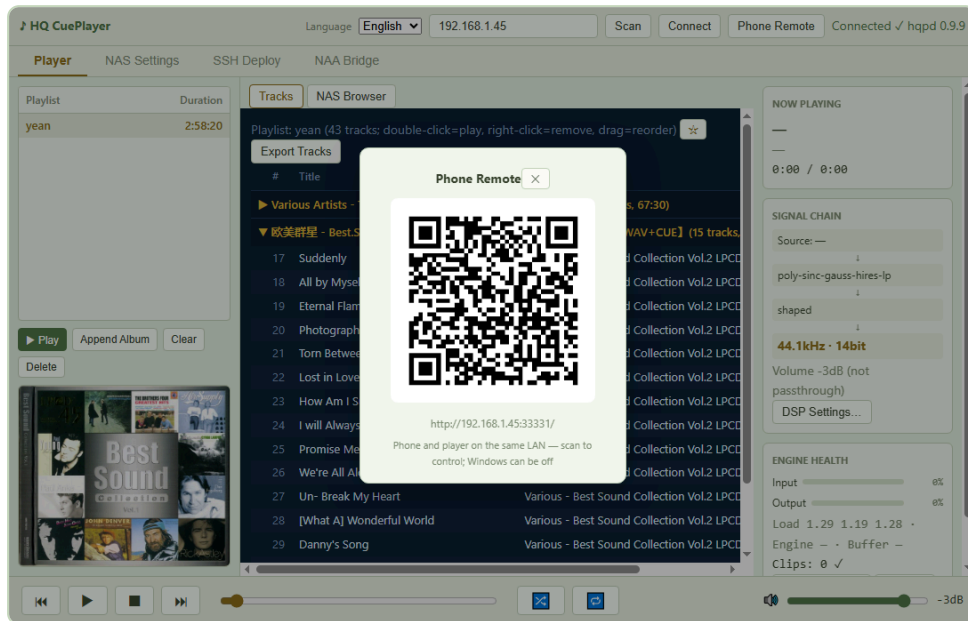


Fig. 5 — Scan to control; Windows can be off afterwards

## 9. NAA bridge

If your DAC hangs off a second device (NAA), the **NAA Bridge** page provides an independent SSH channel: connection test, shutdown, reboot and custom commands, with credentials stored separately from the player. Playback control itself doesn't need this page — it's a convenience for tinkerers.

HQ CuePlayer

LanguageEnglish192.168.1.45ScanConnectPhone RemoteConnected ✓ hqpd 0.9.9

PlayerNAS SettingsSSH DeployNAA Bridge

NAA BRIDGE (INDEPENDENT SSH TO 2ND DEVICE)

Independent channel from the player; credentials saved separately, no redeploy needed

NAA device IP

192.168.1.20

SSH User / Password

rootPassword

TestShutdownReboot

Copy LogClear Log

NAA CUSTOM COMMANDS

Run on NAA device; multi-line scripts / Ctrl+Enter

Enter Linux command

Run

Fig. 6 — NAA bridge management

## 10. License & activation

|                                                | Free                     | Pro                          |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------|
| CUE playback                                   | First 5 tracks per album | Unlimited                    |
| Manual DSP / Learn All Filters                 | ✓                        | ✓                            |
| DSP presets / direct rate / image splitting    | —                        | ✓                            |
| Cross-album advance / playlists / phone remote | 1 playlist × 10 tracks   | ✓ Unlimited                  |
| Duration                                       | Forever, no watermarking | Perpetual, one-time purchase |

To activate: copy the **Machine ID** from the License panel (NAS Settings page, bottom-right) and send it to the seller. Import the `license.lic` you receive via **Import License File**. The license is bound to the player's hardware and verified **fully offline** — no internet connection, no phone-home, ever.

The free tier is forever — no time limit, no audio watermarking. Please evaluate thoroughly on your own hardware before purchasing.

## 11. FAQ

### `ssh: handshake failed: EOF` on deploy or mount?

The player's SSH service (dropbear) rate-limits rapid repeated connections. Wait 1–2 minutes and retry — it is not a wrong password.

### Can't connect to the player?

① Confirm the PC and player are on the same LAN. ② Use Scan — the IP may have changed. ③ Re-run Deploy to make sure hqpd is installed and running.

### NAS mount fails?

Click Test first. Port unreachable → check IP/firewall. Port reachable but mount fails → check the log: nine times out of ten it's a typo in the share path or credentials. For ancient NAS boxes, switch the protocol to SMB 2.0 or 1.0.

### Garbled CUE titles?

Shouldn't happen. Worldwide charset auto-detection is built in — GBK, Big5, Shift-JIS, EUC-KR, UTF-8 and Windows-125x are all handled.

### **Stuttering, or the Clips counter climbing?**

Stuttering: engine overload — lower the rate or pick a lighter filter. Clipping: too much gain in the DSP chain — pull volume down 1–2 dB.

### **Reinstalling the OS — do I need a new license?**

No. The license binds to the hardware (board + NIC). Re-import your original license.lic after reinstalling. For a new machine, contact the seller.

### **Does it collect any data?**

No. There is no telemetry of any kind. License verification is offline, and all configuration lives on your own PC and player.

#### **Disclaimer**

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